

WITNESS STATEMENT

Rivergate Police Department — Traffic Investigation Unit

300 Rivergate Plaza, Rivergate, CA 91766 · (626) 555-0111

Incident: Bus-vs.-standard/pedestrian collision — S. Main Street
Incident Date/Time: 10/18/2025, approx. 02:05 a.m.
RPD Case No.: referenced Officer R. Delacruz (Badge #2814)
Statement taken by: Officer R. Delacruz, RPD
Location statement taken: RPD Field Command Post, S. Main at Third Ave.
Date/time statement taken: 10/18/2025, 03:45 a.m.

WITNESS IDENTIFICATION

Full name: Terrence Blau
Date of birth: 11/08/1994
Home address: 1103 Beacon Street, Rivergate, CA 91766
Contact phone: (626) 555-0163
Occupation: Line cook, Palisade Grill (downtown Rivergate)
Relationship to any party: None. Passenger on the bus. Did not know the operator or the other two riders before tonight.

STATEMENT (in witness's own words, reduced to writing by Officer Delacruz)

My name is Terrence Blau. I'm giving this statement voluntarily. I was a passenger on the ACTD bus tonight — I'm told the bus number was 4177. I wasn't hurt. Just shaken up.

I got off my shift at the Palisade around 01:20 a.m. on 10/18/2025. I walked over to the S. Main stop — the one a couple blocks north of Third — because I ride the Owl bus home most nights I close. I've done that run for probably a year and a half. The bus pulled up around 01:40 a.m., give or take a couple of minutes. It was on time as far as I could tell; nothing about the route or the sign in the window struck me as unusual. I've ridden this same line dozens of times.

When I got on and tapped my card, I said hi to the driver like I usually do. He kind of grunted back. He was heavy-lidded, sort of slumped in the seat — I'd describe him as tired or slow-reacting. When he answered me about the fare, his breath had a pretty clear smell of alcohol. I don't mean a whiff — I mean I noticed it and I remember thinking about it. I did not say anything to him about it. In hindsight I wish I had. Officer Delacruz has told me the operator's name is Keeler; I did not know his name at the time.

There were two other people already on the bus when I boarded. Both women. One was toward the front on the right side — she looked young, maybe college-aged, and she had a backpack. I have since been told her name is Cho. The other woman was a few rows further back on the left, wearing what looked like scrubs or a uniform. I've been told her name is Mowbray. Nobody else got on or off between when I boarded and when the crash happened. It was just the three of us in the back.

I sat down on the right side, about halfway back. I put my earbuds in but I didn't have music playing loud — I could still hear the road. The bus was going southbound on S. Main. I wasn't paying close attention to the speed, but it felt normal, maybe a little quick for that hour but not crazy. I remember we passed one or two green lights.

Then the bus drifted. That's the best word for it. It didn't swerve — it drifted, like nobody was correcting it. It went to the right, toward the curb, and I looked up because I could feel it. Before I could really say anything, there was a hard jolt — a bang — and I got thrown forward against the seat in front of me. Officer Delacruz has told me that first impact was the light pole. That matches what I saw when I got out — the pole was down and the light above the intersection was dark.

Almost right after that first hit — I would say a second, maybe two seconds later — there was a second impact. Softer than the first, but definitely a second thump. The bus finally came to a stop. I did not see what the second impact was from inside. I was on the right side and it happened up ahead of me and low. I have since been told, and I have no reason to doubt it, that the second impact was the pedestrian.

The bus wasn't moving anymore. The engine was still running. The driver — Keeler — was still in the seat but he wasn't really doing anything. He wasn't reaching for the radio, he wasn't standing up, he wasn't looking around. He looked like he was blinking a lot and trying to figure out where he was. He did not say anything to us that I heard.

The woman I now know as Cho was crying and holding her leg. The other one, Mowbray, was pressed against the window on her side and holding her neck. I asked both of them if they were okay and Cho said her leg was broken — she was pretty sure. Mowbray said her neck hurt.

I got up and I went to the front. I hit the door release — the yellow strip by the door — and stepped down onto the street. I looked at the front of the bus. The right front was pushed in and there was a person on the ground a few feet in front of the bus. It was a woman. She wasn't moving. I did not go closer than maybe eight or ten feet because I could see there was already blood and I did not want to touch her or move her. I have some basic first-aid from work but not for something like that.

I got my phone out and dialed 911. When the dispatcher picked up I told them there had been a bus crash at S. Main and Third and there was a pedestrian down and passengers hurt. The dispatcher told me another caller was already on the line reporting the same thing — I later learned that was probably Cho or Mowbray from inside the bus, or somebody from a nearby building. I stayed on with 911 anyway until the first RPD unit rolled up, which was only a couple of minutes.

While I was waiting I did not go back on the bus. I stayed on the sidewalk on the west side. I could see Keeler through the windshield. He got up out of the driver's seat at some point and stood in the aisle but he didn't come outside on his own. When the officers arrived he came off the bus with them.

That's what I remember. I'm giving this statement about four hours after the crash and I'm doing my best to be accurate. If I remember anything more I'll add it.

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS ASKED BY OFFICER DELACRUZ

Q: Did the operator appear to fall asleep at any point?

A: I couldn't see his face from where I was sitting. He looked tired when I got on. Whether he closed his eyes right before the crash, I can't say for sure. What I can say is the bus drifted like nobody was steering it.

Q: Did you see the pedestrian before the impact?

A: No. I did not see her at all before the crash. I saw her on the ground after.

Q: Was anyone else on the bus besides you, Cho, and Mowbray?

A: No. Three of us total riding, plus the driver. Nobody got on or off after I boarded.

Q: Had you consumed any alcohol or drugs tonight?

A: No. I was coming straight off a closing shift. I hadn't had anything.

Q: When you smelled alcohol on the operator, how confident are you?

A: Very. It wasn't subtle. I've worked in kitchens and bars for years — I know what alcohol on somebody's breath smells like at close range.

ATTESTATION

I have read this statement, or had it read back to me, and it is true and correct to the best of my recollection. I understand this statement may be used in a criminal or civil proceeding.

Signed: [signed] Terrence Blau
Date: 10/18/2025
Time: 04:12 a.m.
Witness (Officer): R. Delacruz, RPD #2814
Date: 10/18/2025

SIGNED CORRECTIONS / ADDENDUM — 10/22/2025

I have re-read my statement of 10/18/2025 and I want to make the following corrections and clarifications. I am initialing each change on the original page as well.

1. **Boarding time.** In my original statement I said "around 01:40 a.m., give or take a couple of minutes." Having thought about it more and checked my phone's call and text log for that night, I am comfortable saying I boarded at approximately 01:40 a.m. I do not want to be more precise than that.
2. **Order of impacts.** In my original statement I said the second impact was "a second, maybe two seconds" after the first. I want to clarify that I was not counting. It felt very close together — essentially back-to-back. It could have been shorter than that. What I am sure of is that there were two distinct impacts and the light pole was first.
3. **Operator's demeanor at fare payment.** I stand by what I said about the smell of alcohol on the operator's breath when I paid my fare. I want to add that he also fumbled with the farebox — he reached for a button on the console twice before he settled. I did not mention that on 10/18/2025 because I had forgotten it. It came back to me the next day.
4. **Identification of the other riders.** I did not know either of the other two riders on 10/18/2025. I have since been shown their names — Devin Cho and Alicia Mowbray — by Officer Delacruz and by an ACTD Safety representative. I did not know them before the crash and I have not spoken with them since.
5. **Direction of travel.** In my original statement I said the bus was "going southbound on S. Main." Officer Delacruz has since shown me the AVL/GPS track and the run schedule, and I understand the bus was traveling northbound at the time. I was disoriented and did not check a compass or landmark - I was going on feel, and I got it wrong.

Except as corrected above, my original 10/18/2025 statement stands as written. This addendum is true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

Signed: [signed] Terrence Blau
Date: 10/22/2025
Witness (Officer): R. Delacruz, RPD #2814
Date: 10/22/2025

Original statement retained in RPD case file. Copy transmitted to ACTD Safety (attn: M. Okonkwo) and to the Los Angeles County District Attorney's Office pursuant to the criminal referral.